

Internship Host Quick-Reference

Vitchakorn (Blue) Poonyakanok, Summer 2027 Internship

CARNEGIE MELLON UNIVERSITY

Heinz College, M.S. Health Care Analytics & IT
(MSHCA)

Last updated: August 21, 2026

WHO I AM

Physician and clinical data analyst from Bangkok, Thailand, now based in Pittsburgh, PA as a current M.S. student in Health Care Analytics and Information Technology at Carnegie Mellon University's Heinz College (August 2026 – May 2028). Background spans travel medicine, field epidemiology and outbreak investigation with Thailand's Ministry of Public Health, and applied health data analytics: clinical AI tools, public health dashboards, and disease-surveillance systems.

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE & WHAT I CAN CONTRIBUTE

In an 8–12 week placement, I can contribute directly to analytics, dashboarding, or surveillance/evaluation work, for example:

- Built a disease-surveillance dashboard and LLM-based query assistant for Thailand's national disease-control agency, using tool-calling over aggregate, privacy-safe data.
- Designed a Tableau dashboard for yellow fever and malaria travel-prevention guidance, built on CDC Yellow Book data.
- Evaluated a national digital disease-surveillance system's sensitivity, timeliness, and representativeness, and recommended improvements.

INTERNSHIP WINDOW

Eligible window	May 11 – Aug 20, 2027
Minimum hours	300 hours
Duration needed	8–12 wks, full-time
Location	Pittsburgh or anywhere in U.S.
Compensation	Paid or unpaid OK

ELIGIBLE HOST TYPES

- Public agency
- Non-profit organization
- Private firm

Per Heinz College policy, the role must have **significant educational value in management and analysis**, not purely clerical work.

ACADEMIC OVERSIGHT

- Internship is verified and formally approved by CMU Heinz College Career Services before it counts toward my degree requirement.
- At the end of the term, my supervisor completes a brief (~10 minute) performance evaluation form; no ongoing reporting burden during the internship itself.
- No academic credit is issued for the internship; it is not a stipend-generating placement for the university, and there is no cost or contractual obligation to the host organization.

WORK AUTHORIZATION: WHAT HOSTING ACTUALLY REQUIRES

Status: J-1 Exchange Visitor, sponsored by Carnegie Mellon University

Authorization required: **Academic Training (AT)**, requested through CMU's Office of International Education. This is not CPT, not an H-1B, and not a petition the host files.

- AT must be approved before my start date. Processing typically takes a few weeks; I will file as soon as an offer is confirmed, well ahead of May 2027.
- **Host-side requirement is minimal:** a brief offer / role description letter for my AT application: no sponsorship fee, no immigration petition, no legal filing on the host's part.
- I am responsible for securing and completing my own authorization; this does not require action from the host beyond that one letter.

FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS

- **Is there a cost to host me?** No sponsorship fee, stipend, or contractual cost; compensation is optional (paid or unpaid).
- **Do you need to sponsor a visa?** No: CMU sponsors my J-1 status; hosting only requires one brief offer letter.
- **What if my degree plans change?** Heinz College Career Services approves the internship independently of the host.
- **Is remote work acceptable?** Yes, for U.S.-based remote/hybrid roles; I am based in Pittsburgh, PA and can relocate for the window.